

Comparing Written Numerals 1 through 10

Answer Key

Kindergarten–Grade 1

Quick Answers

1. —	4. 8, 5	7. 4, 6, 9	10. 7, 8, —
2. —	5. 2, 7	8. 5, —	
3. —	6. —	9. 10, 7, 3	

1. Compare 3 and 7.

Solution: Count up: 1, 2, 3, ... — you say 3 first, then keep counting to 7. The numeral said later is greater, so 7 is greater and 3 is less. The open end of the symbol faces 7:

$3 < 7$ “three is less than seven.”

2. Compare 9 and 4.

Solution: Counting up you say 4 first and 9 later, so 9 is the greater numeral. It is written first here, so the open end of the symbol faces left, toward 9: $9 > 4$ “nine is greater than four.”

3. Compare 6 and 6.

Solution: Both numerals name the same amount — six counters and six counters. Neither is said later when counting, so neither is greater; the correct symbol is the equal sign:

$6 = 6$.

4. Circle the numeral that is greater: 8 or 5.

Solution: Counting up you say 5 first and 8 later, so 8 is the greater numeral — circle 8. Written greater-first, the pair is $8 > 5$.

5. Circle the numeral that is less: 7 or 2.

Solution: Counting up you say 2 first, so 2 is the smaller numeral — circle 2. Written smaller-first, the pair is $2 < 7$.

6. Compare 10 and 8.

Solution: 10 has two digits and 8 has one, but the safe check is still counting: after 8 you say 9, then 10, so 10 comes later and is greater. Do not be tricked by the small 1 at the front of 10: $10 > 8$.

7. Write 4, 9, 6 from least to greatest.

Solution: Find the one you say first when counting up: 4. Of the two left, 6 is said before 9. So the order is $4, 6, 9$.

8. Mia starts at 2 and counts on 3 more. Write Mia’s numeral, then compare it with 9.

Solution: Counting on three from 2: 3, 4, 5. Mia’s numeral is 5 . Now compare 5 with 9: counting up you say 5 first and 9 later, so 5 is less: $5 < 9$ (“five is less than nine”).

9. Write 10, 3, 7 from greatest to least.

Solution: Find the one you say last when counting up: 10. Of the two left, 7 is said after 3. So greatest to least is $\boxed{10, 7, 3}$.

10. Sam's numeral is 1 more than 6. Ana's numeral is 1 less than 9. Write both numerals, then compare them.

Solution: One more than 6 means count on one: Sam's numeral is $\boxed{7}$. One less than 9 means count back one: Ana's numeral is $\boxed{8}$. Finish both counts *before* comparing. Counting up you say 7 first and 8 later, so Sam's numeral is less than Ana's: $\boxed{<}$.